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📱 ТЕХНОЛОГИЯ

17 июля 1984 года миллионы людей смотрели в прямом эфире по телевизору, как разбивается поезд. Это была не обычная авария

Поезд против контейнера с ядерными отходами: кто победит?



ДЖЕЙМС ФЕЛТОН



Старший Штатный писатель

Джеймс — писатель, автор множества научно-популярных книг по истории и естественным наукам. Он специализируется на истории, космосе, необычных научных явлениях и всем необычном.

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Один из забытых телевизионных жанров, который нам нужно немедленно возродить: сталкивать что-то опасное с чем-то другим и наблюдать за последующим взрывом.

В 2012 году продюсеры из Великобритании, США и Германии купили Boeing 727 и разбили его о высохшее дно озера в Мексике, чтобы ответить на извечный вопрос: где лучше сидеть во время авиакатастрофы, если ваша главная цель — выжить?

В 1984 году телепродюсеры ответили на еще один классический вопрос, который был у всех на слуху: что произойдет, если поезд врежется в ядерную боеголовку на скорости около 160 километров в час (100 миль в час)?

17 июля 1984 года миллионы людей по всему миру смотрели именно это. Тем временем около 2000 приглашенных гостей наблюдали за тем, как локомотив British Rail класса 46 мчался прямо на колбу, чтобы проверить ее безопасность.

Так что же такое ядерные «колбы» или «бочки»? Должны ли ядерные отходы храниться на ядерных объектах или быть захоронены глубоко под землей в какой-нибудь ужасной ядерной «могиле», которую нельзя вскрывать в течение 1000 лет? Ну, в каком-то смысле да. Но время от времени их нужно перевозить, например для переработки в другом месте, и когда возникает такая необходимость, отходы обычно перевозят в этих гигантских «колбах», часто в вагонах-цистернах.

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WANG Minghuan, Journal of Harbin Institute of Technology, 2025

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Communications in Transportation Research , 2025

Transport planning for an Olympic Games [↗](#)

Peter Hendy, Journal of Urban Regeneration & Renewal, 2012

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"They are typically made from 25-cm-thick [about 10 inches] forged steel and weigh around 100 tonnes. They can hold up to five tonnes of nuclear material," Pacific Nuclear Transport, Ltd explains. "The casks facilitate the movement of nuclear material by

different modes of transport, protect workers from radiation, dissipate heat efficiently and are designed to withstand severe accidents."

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And boy, as millions learned in 1984, can they withstand accidents. Put one of these beauties up against a train going 100 miles an hour, and we wouldn't bet on the train.

Train test crash 1984 - nuclear flask test

Fleetline119

As expected, after a 12.9-kilometer (8-mile) runup, the train hit the nuclear flask and was obliterated. More reassuringly, the flask remained intact, losing very little pressure during the deliberate crash.

So what did we learn from this? Not a whole lot that couldn't have been found out through more conventional tests, but the point of the crash was as a demonstration to the public that nuclear material could safely be transported across the country.

"These flasks are ultra, ultra safe," Walter Marshall, chairman of the Central Electricity Generating Board, said in a [TV interview](#) shortly after the crash. "People shouldn't worry

at all about the transport of spent fuel."

"The general public really ought to be satisfied. I mean it's been expensive, but I think they ought to be satisfied and and that makes it worth it," he added.

While it is unclear how many people worried about nuclear waste would be fully converted to the idea after watching a train smash into it expensively, protests around transport have died down in the intervening years.

Meanwhile, a lot of nuclear waste has been transported across the UK.

"In 2014, Public Health England estimated that, each year, approximately 110,000 transport containers were moved on the road, with 1,500 moved on the rail network," Sarah Bryson, a Transportation Specialist with Nuclear Waste Services explained to [South Copeland GDF Community Partnership](#), a nuclear disposal facility.

"They have all occurred without a single major safety incident, since nuclear transport began in the 1960s. This unblemished safety record is due to robust management and packages undergo rigorous testing to ensure they remain safe no matter what happens to them."

More conventional testing, she added, involved dropping the casks from various heights, and subjecting them to temperatures of up to 800°C (1,472 degrees Fahrenheit).

🕒 ORIGINALLY PUBLISHED JUNE 11, 2026

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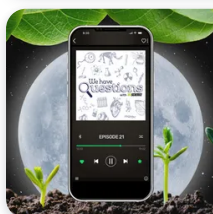
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